

NEW JOINER FAQ

First-week checklist and department-specific onboarding guide

Effective date	14 September 2026	Document owner	People Operations
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Purpose

This guide gives every new employee a consistent first-week plan and adds tasks based on the employee's department. The Employee Assistant should resolve the employee's identity and department before returning a personalized checklist.

Knowledge-base note	This is a demonstration policy document. Replace contacts, systems, deadlines, and benefits with approved company information before production use.
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1. How personalization works

The personalized checklist is the **Universal Checklist** plus the checklist for the employee's verified department. The assistant must not guess a department from the employee's name, job title, or wording.

Recommended assistant flow

1	Ask for the employee ID if it is missing.
2	Resolve the employee identity using the approved employee directory tool.
3	Use the verified department returned by the tool; do not ask the employee to supply it when verification succeeds.
4	Return the universal tasks plus the matching department tasks.
5	If verification fails, ask the employee to check the ID or contact People Operations.

If a department is not listed, return the Universal Checklist and advise the employee to confirm additional tasks with their manager or People Operations.

2. Universal first-week checklist

Applies to every new employee, regardless of department.

Complete during the first week

Done	Task	Owner / contact
☐	Complete identity, payroll, tax, emergency-contact, and bank-detail forms.	People Operations
☐	Collect the employee ID badge and confirm office-access permissions.	Workplace / Security
☐	Receive the assigned laptop, charger, and approved accessories; acknowledge receipt.	IT Service Desk
☐	Activate the company account, email, multi-factor authentication, and password recovery.	IT Service Desk
☐	Review the code of conduct, information-security policy, acceptable-use policy, working hours, leave policy, and remote-work policy.	Employee
☐	Complete mandatory security, privacy, workplace-safety, and compliance training.	Learning portal
☐	Meet the line manager to review the role, first-month priorities, success measures, and meeting cadence.	Line manager
☐	Meet the assigned buddy and immediate team; confirm communication channels and calendars.	Line manager / Buddy
☐	Request any missing hardware, software, shared-drive, or system access through the approved request process.	Employee / Manager
☐	Confirm completion of the first-week onboarding review.	Employee / Line manager

3. Department-specific checklists

Add only the checklist that matches the department returned by the approved employee directory.

Engineering & Technology

Done	Task	Owner / contact
☐	Set up the approved development environment, repositories, package registries, and VPN.	Engineering manager / IT
☐	Request access to required cloud, test, monitoring, ticketing, and documentation environments.	Manager / System owners
☐	Review coding standards, branching and review practices, secure-development rules, and deployment process.	Technical lead
☐	Run the starter project or complete a supervised test change without using production data.	Technical lead / Buddy
☐	Review architecture, service ownership, incident escalation, and on-call expectations if applicable.	Engineering manager

Sales & Business Development

Done	Task	Owner / contact
☐	Receive CRM access and review opportunity, activity, and forecasting requirements.	Sales operations
☐	Review the product portfolio, approved pricing, proposal templates, and sales stages.	Sales manager
☐	Complete confidentiality, client-data handling, and approved-claims guidance.	Compliance / Manager
☐	Shadow a discovery call or mock client presentation.	Sales manager / Buddy
☐	Review assigned accounts, territory, targets, and approval paths for discounts.	Sales manager

Marketing & Communications

Done	Task	Owner / contact
☐	Request access to approved brand assets, content calendar, analytics, and campaign tools.	Marketing operations
☐	Review brand, social-media, external-communications, and approval guidelines.	Marketing manager
☐	Learn the campaign briefing, review, publishing, and reporting workflow.	Campaign owner
☐	Review current campaigns, target audiences, KPIs, and agency contacts.	Marketing manager
☐	Complete a sample content or campaign brief for feedback.	Buddy / Manager

Finance & Procurement

Done	Task	Owner / contact
☐	Request access to the approved finance, procurement, and expense systems required for the role.	Finance systems owner
☐	Review purchasing limits, segregation of duties, approval matrix, and vendor onboarding rules.	Finance manager
☐	Complete financial-control, fraud-awareness, and confidential-data training.	Compliance
☐	Review the month-end calendar, reporting deadlines, and document-retention requirements.	Finance manager
☐	Practice a non-production expense, purchase request, or reconciliation workflow.	Buddy

Human Resources / People Operations

Done	Task	Owner / contact
☐	Request role-based access to the HR information system and approved employee-document repository.	HR systems owner
☐	Review employee-data privacy, confidentiality, retention, and access-control requirements.	HR manager / Privacy
☐	Review recruitment, onboarding, leave, employee-relations, and letter-request workflows relevant to the role.	HR manager
☐	Learn the escalation path for sensitive, safeguarding, ethics, and grievance matters.	HR leadership
☐	Shadow one approved HR workflow using test or redacted data.	Buddy

Operations & Customer Support

Done	Task	Owner / contact
☐	Request access to ticketing, operations dashboards, knowledge tools, and approved communication channels.	Operations manager / IT
☐	Review service levels, ticket priorities, handoff rules, quality standards, and escalation paths.	Team lead
☐	Complete customer-data handling and approved-communication training.	Compliance / Quality
☐	Shadow customer cases or an operational shift before handling work independently.	Buddy / Team lead
☐	Practice documenting and escalating a sample case in the training environment.	Team lead

4. New joiner FAQ

What should I do before my first day?

Confirm your start date, office or remote location, reporting time, manager contact, identification requirements, and any forms requested by People Operations.

What should I bring on my first day?

Bring a valid identification document and any documents specifically requested by People Operations. Do not bring or upload sensitive documents through unapproved channels.

Where should I report?

Use the location and time stated in your official welcome message. If they are missing, contact your manager or People Operations before your start time.

When will I receive my laptop and badge?

These should normally be issued during onboarding. If either is unavailable, ask your manager to confirm the temporary working arrangement and submit the appropriate request.

How do I get software or system access?

Use the approved access-request process. Include the business reason and system name. Access requiring approval will be sent to the relevant manager or system owner.

What if I cannot sign in?

Contact the IT Service Desk. Never share your password or multi-factor authentication code with another person.

Who explains my responsibilities?

Your line manager should explain your role, objectives, priorities, expected working arrangements, and first-month success measures.

Who can answer everyday questions?

Start with your assigned buddy or line manager. Use the Employee Assistant for approved policy information and request services.

How do I learn my working hours and remote-work eligibility?

Check the approved working-hours and remote-work policies. Eligibility may depend on role, location, department, operational needs, and manager approval.

How do I request leave?

Submit a leave request through the approved employee request process. Provide the leave type and dates. Approval is not guaranteed until the request is confirmed.

How do I request an HR letter?

Use the HR-letter request process and specify the letter type, language, addressee, and purpose when required.

How do I report a security concern?

Immediately report suspicious messages, lost equipment, exposed credentials, or unintended data access through the official security or IT channel. Do not investigate on your own.

What if my department checklist is missing?

Complete the Universal Checklist and ask your manager or People Operations for role-specific tasks. The assistant must not invent requirements.

What if my employee ID cannot be verified?

Check that the ID is entered correctly. If verification still fails, contact People Operations. The assistant should not disclose employee details or guess your identity.

What should be completed by the end of week one?

Core employment forms, account activation, equipment receipt, mandatory policy reviews, essential training, manager and team introductions, and all immediately required access requests should be completed or actively tracked.

5. Escalation and safe-answer rules

Situation	Required response
Employee identity cannot be verified	Ask the employee to check the ID or contact People Operations. Do not reveal directory data.
Department is unavailable or unmapped	Provide the Universal Checklist only and refer the employee to their manager or People Operations for additions.
The answer is not in the approved knowledge base	Say that the information could not be confirmed and direct the employee to the appropriate owner. Do not invent an answer.
A request must be submitted	Collect only the required fields, summarize the request for confirmation where needed, call the approved request tool, and return the request ID.
A request status is requested	Verify the employee as required, use the request ID, and return only the authorized status and next action.
Sensitive or emergency issue	Use the official urgent escalation channel. Do not place secrets, passwords, medical details, or unnecessary personal data in a general request.

Document maintenance

People Operations should review this guide whenever onboarding steps, systems, department structures, or escalation contacts change. The knowledge-base version should display an effective date and replace outdated versions.